Week 7 Preview

1 message

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Thu, Oct 22, 2026 at 4:02 AM

SUMERSPORTS



Week 7 Preview

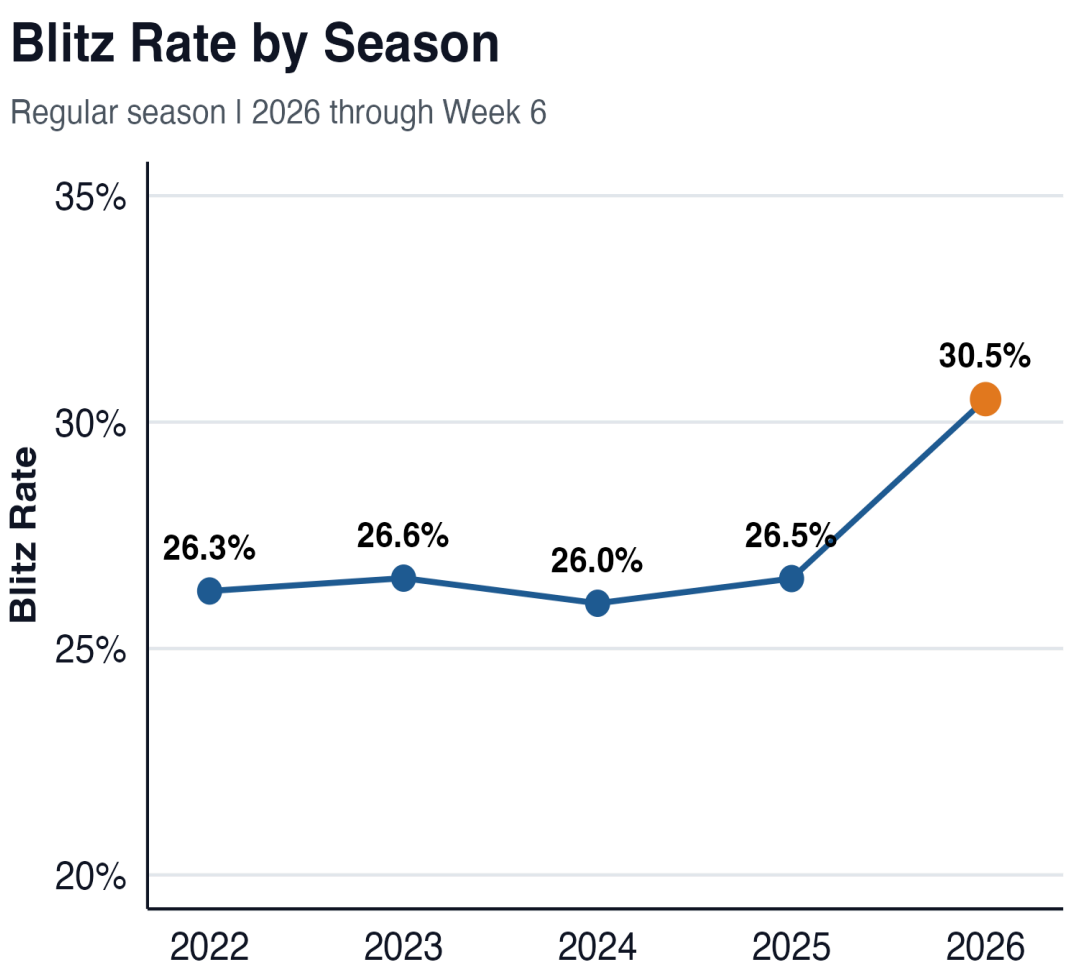
A Quick Note.

- The data you see below comes from SumerSports' SumerPass. We recommend you check it out if you want to dive deeper into the data, build your own stats, or get live charting on game days.
- Today's newsletter has some thoughts on blitzing across the league, our film favorites, and our biggest questions of the week along with their respective

preview boxes. For the rest of the game preview boxes, head over to Tej's page where they will all be posted on Thursday.

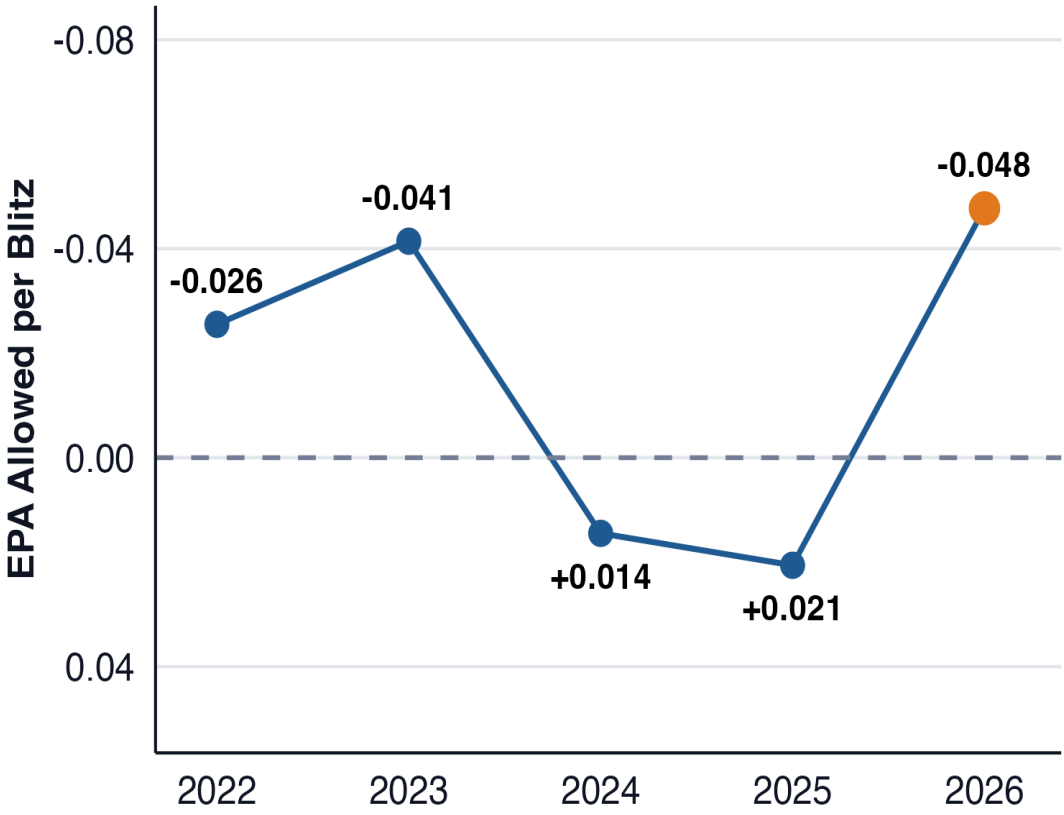
Blitzing is Back!

Let's get blitzing.



- Blitzing has always been a tool for defenses, but we have lived in a world of limiting explosives and forcing long drives for the last few years. We noticed an uptick in blitzes this year as a response to under center offenses but also in 3rd and pass situations. The above graph shows overall blitz rate changes from year to year.

Blitzes are also much more effective this year.

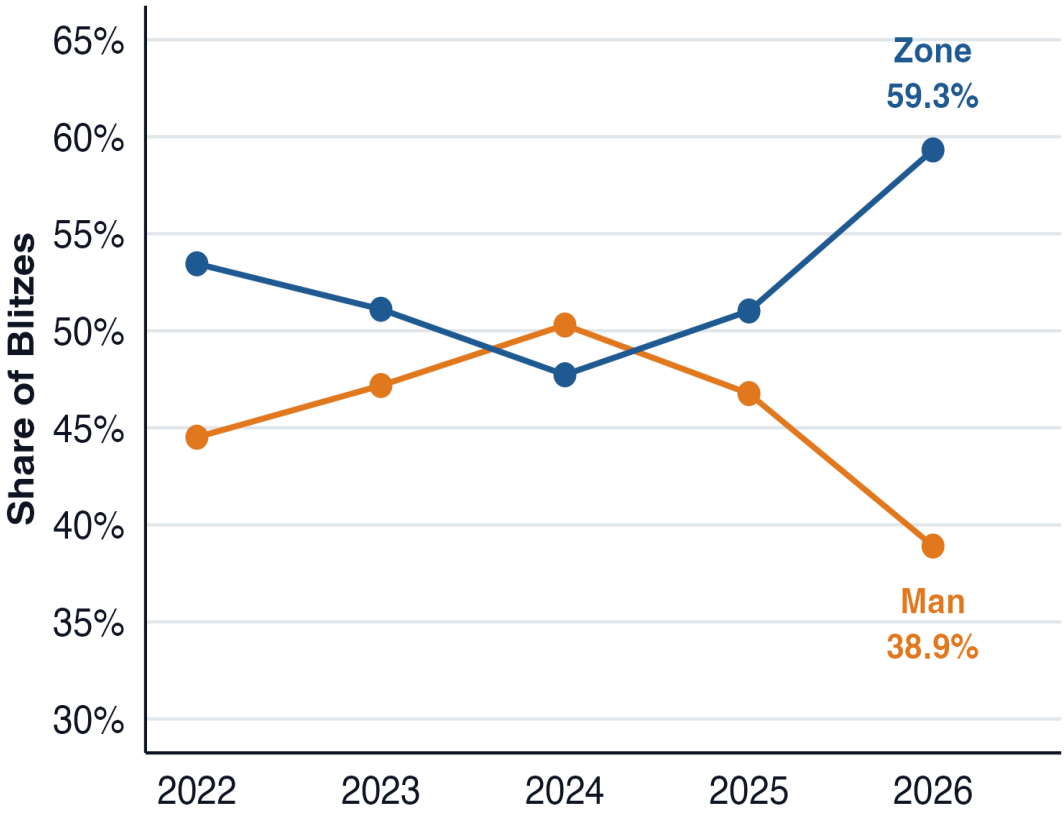


- To a more important point, blitzes have been more effective this year. In particular, a very common blitz path with a linebacker and defensive back to the weak side of an offensive formation has been demolishing quarterbacks. Blitzes with a defensive back and linebacker both firing have led to a -0.7 EPA/dropback allowed and a 20.1% success rate allowed on 3rd and long.

Teams are playing more zone coverage behind their blitzes.

Man vs. Zone Behind Blitzes

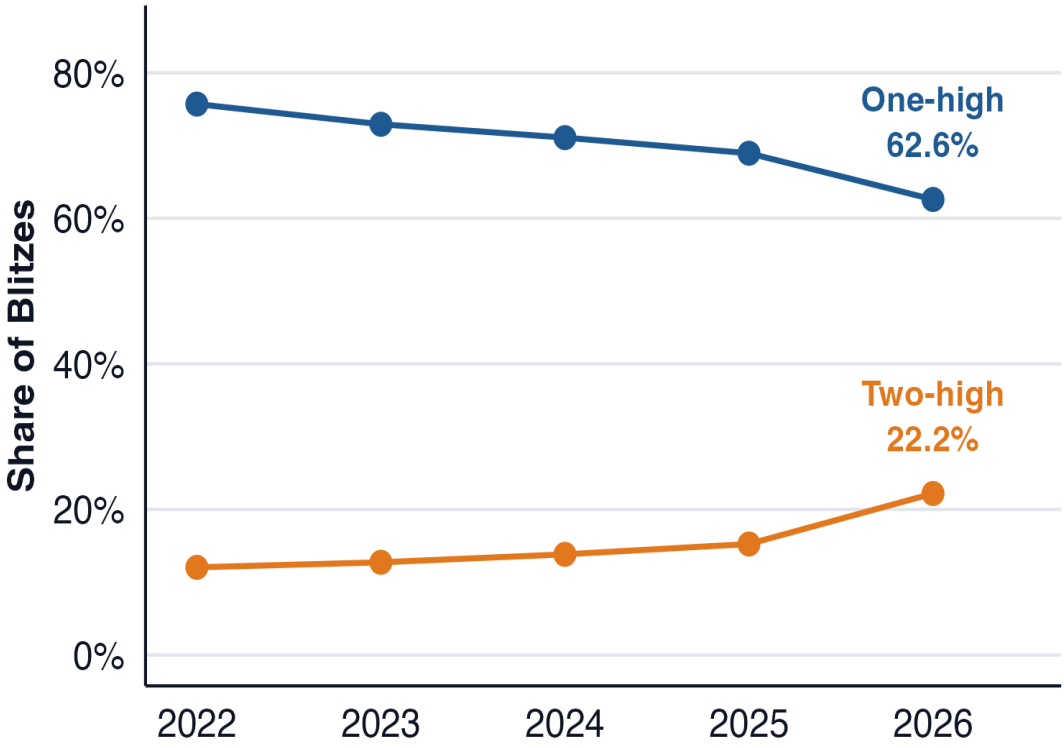
Regular season | 2026 through Week 6



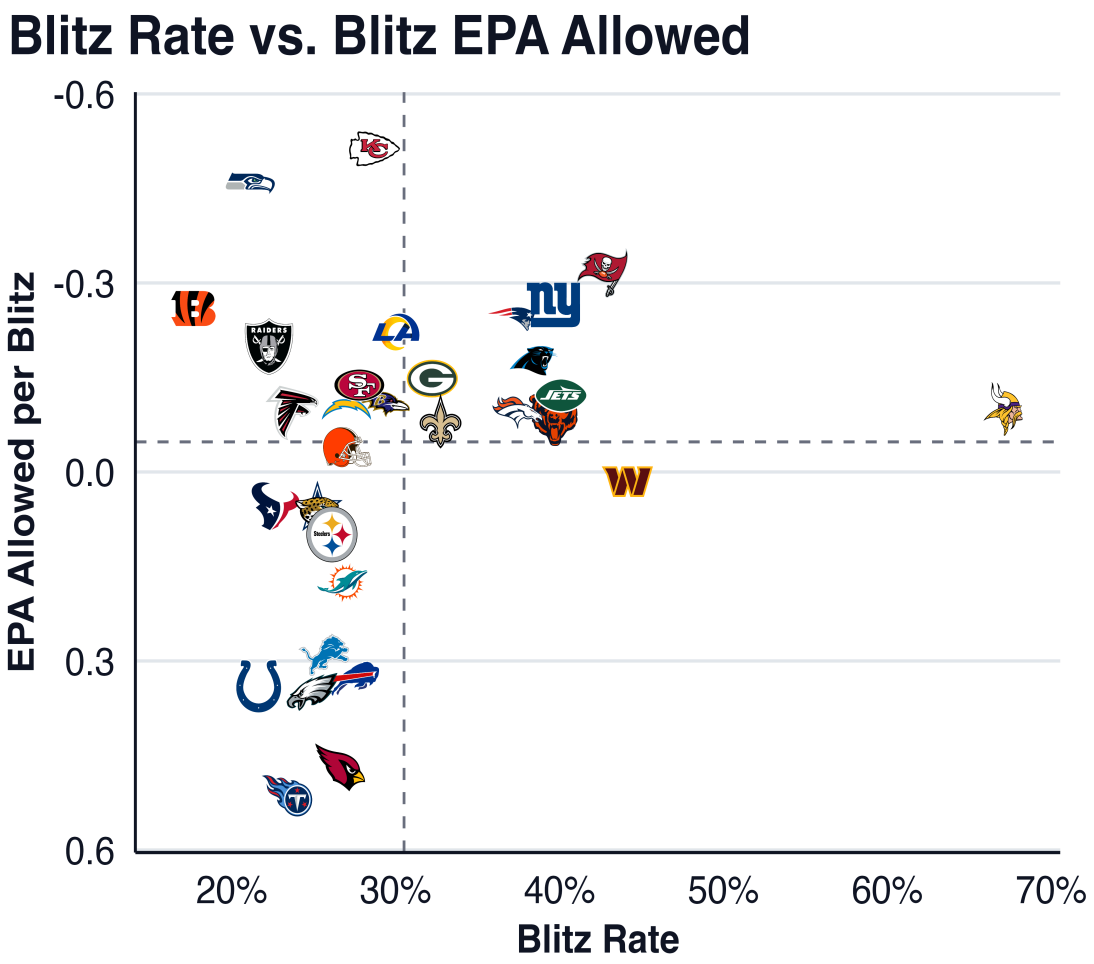
- While fire zones can play out like man coverage at times, we are seeing a much larger percentage of teams playing zone behind their blitzes. There is always risk when you void space in your coverage with a blitz, but teams that are comfortable playing versions of their two high coverages while trapping a running back in pass protection can be sound in coverage while getting an advantageous 1 on 1 in the rush.

One-High vs. Two-High Behind Blitzes

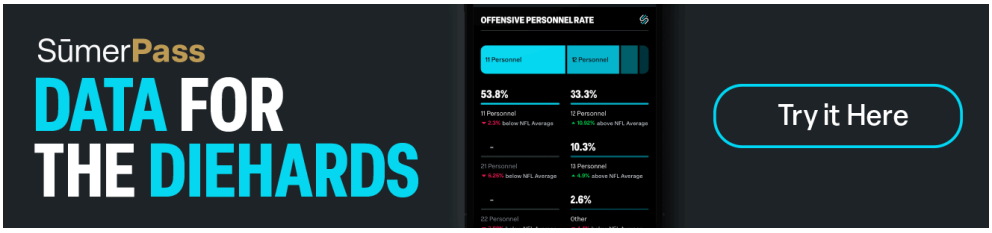
Regular season | 2026 through Week 6



Here are how some teams are blitzing this season.



- The Minnesota Vikings are playing a different sport with Brian Flores, and we are always monitoring Mike Macdonald. Macdonald has a tremendous feel for when to send a blitz regardless of his overall blitz rate.
- This season has started to push us away from our roots of rush four and play seven in coverage behind it. When two high to one high rotations became popularized, defenses were forcing quarterbacks to process post-snap and be correct over and over. Some of the best blitz looks we are seeing across the league this year force more pre-snap work to sort protection with an uncertainty post-snap that can lead to huge wins for the defense.



Film Favorites

Here are some interesting things from the all-22 this week with clips hyperlinked:

- Getting your wide receiver matched up on a linebacker.
- Two double moves on shorter routes.
- Some Declan Doyle deviousness.
- A rarely seen safety rotation.
- A popular blitz against a different offensive look.
- Post snap movement on the defensive line helping create tackles for loss.
- Getting bigger bodies blocking on a perimeter screen.
- The slo-mo throw of the week.

Questions We Want Answered

Will the Patriots defense stifle Caleb Williams?

- The Patriots defense is 3rd in EPA/dropback allowed against non-play action dropbacks but 30th against play action plays. Chicago runs play action at one of the highest rates in the league so we will be focused on how the Bears try to get the Patriots defense playing downhill before crossers are sent over the middle.
- In Caleb Williams' first game back, he showed a willingness to get to his checkdown, and Ben Johnson structured a screen heavy gameplan. Colston Loveland had a strong target share against the Falcons and will likely find himself in space against New England's linebackers.
- We are curious to see how much New England will blitz the Bears. New England blitzes at the 9th highest rate and is 6th in EPA/dropback allowed on those plays while Caleb Williams is 24th in success rate against the blitz.

CHI Offense vs. NE Defense

Week 7 preview • 2026 Weeks 1-6 data • Each cell shows value and NFL rank

Overall

UNIT	EPA/PLAY	EPA/DB	EPA/RUSH	SUCCESS RATE	PASS OE	EXPLOSIVE %
CHI Offense	-0.00 (#14)	0.05 (#15)	-0.08 (#14)	45.6% (#13)	0.2% (#16)	9.7% (#12)
NE Defense	-0.06 (#15)	-0.06 (#10)	-0.08 (#21)	43.3% (#16)	-0.4% (#12)	8.4% (#12)

Personnel Usage

UNIT	11P %	11P EPA	12P %	12P EPA	13P %	13P EPA
CHI Offense	46.5% (#26)	0.10 (#6)	34.3% (#4)	-0.08 (#22)	17.8% (#4)	-0.09 (#21)
NE Defense	55.8% (#19)	-0.20 (#5)	28.8% (#7)	-0.03 (#15)	5.5% (#24)	0.03 (#15)

Run & Play Action Identity

UNIT	ZONE %	ZONE EPA	PA %	PA EPA	UC %	UC EPA
CHI Offense	67.2% (#6)	-0.11 (#17)	33.3% (#3)	0.03 (#19)	47.1% (#5)	-0.00 (#14)
NE Defense	54.2% (#18)	-0.16 (#11)	23.9% (#23)	0.42 (#30)	39.8% (#11)	0.11 (#28)

Safety Shell & Middle of Field

UNIT	1-HIGH %	1-HIGH EPA	2-HIGH %	2-HIGH EPA	MOF %	MOF EPA
CHI Offense	39.2% (#11)	0.12 (#5)	60.8% (#22)	0.01 (#16)	30.4% (#1)	0.25 (#16)
NE Defense	48.4% (#5)	-0.11 (#13)	51.6% (#28)	-0.01 (#14)	19.8% (#11)	0.52 (#29)

Blitz & Pressure

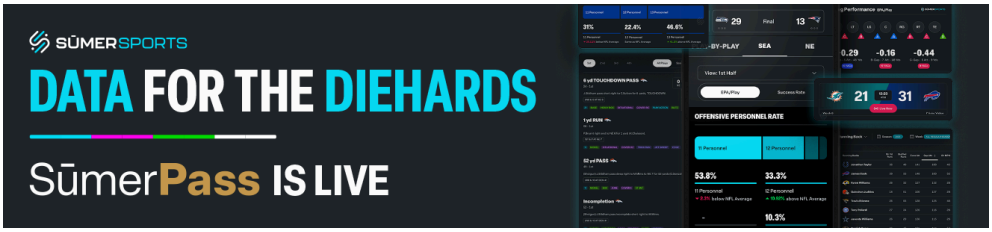
UNIT	BLITZ %	BLITZ EPA	NON-BLITZ EPA	PRESSURE %	PRESSURE EPA
CHI Offense	40.3% (#1)	0.07 (#13)	0.04 (#20)	39.1% (#16)	-0.09 (#6)
NE Defense	37.1% (#9)	-0.24 (#6)	0.05 (#20)	42.7% (#8)	-0.54 (#5)

Pass Depth

UNIT	SHORT %	SHORT EPA	INTER. %	INTER. EPA	DEEP %	DEEP EPA
CHI Offense	70.0% (#7)	0.07 (#11)	21.3% (#18)	0.26 (#21)	8.7% (#26)	0.26 (#22)
NE Defense	71.0% (#7)	0.02 (#17)	20.2% (#18)	0.24 (#16)	8.8% (#28)	0.65 (#23)

Defensive Personnel & Box Count

UNIT	BASE %	BASE EPA	NICKEL %	NICKEL EPA	LIGHT BOX %	LIGHT BOX EPA
CHI Offense	37.5% (#5)	-0.09 (#20)	55.6% (#24)	0.00 (#13)	35.6% (#31)	0.16 (#7)
NE Defense	20.3% (#26)	0.10 (#25)	78.8% (#3)	-0.10 (#12)	35.2% (#29)	-0.15 (#3)



How will the Packers blitz the Lions offense?

- The Lions have the best offense in the league against the blitz this season. Amon-Ra St. Brown sees a massive target share when defenses blitz, and Jared Goff is getting the ball out quicker against pressure than he was last season.
- The Packers had a great blitz plan last week against the Cowboys and showed off some creative coverage rotations. Evan Williams is a threat as a blitzer but can also drop out in coverage from all-up looks.
- The intermediate area of the field is our focus in this game. Sam LaPorta has a tremendous 2.33 EPA/target on intermediate passes, and Jared Goff is more than happy to throw in the 10-19 yard range against the blitz or off play action.

DET Offense vs. GB Defense

Week 7 preview • 2026 Weeks 1-6 data • Each cell shows value and NFL rank

Overall

UNIT	EPA/PLAY	EPA/DB	EPA/RUSH	SUCCESS RATE	PASS OE	EXPLOSIVE %
DET Offense	0.16 (#3)	0.26 (#3)	-0.01 (#6)	50.6% (#2)	2.9% (#9)	10.6% (#10)
GB Defense	-0.11 (#4)	-0.14 (#4)	-0.06 (#27)	43.1% (#14)	-0.2% (#13)	5.9% (#2)

Personnel Usage

UNIT	11P %	11P EPA	12P %	12P EPA	13P %	13P EPA
DET Offense	60.0% (#13)	0.19 (#3)	33.3% (#5)	0.15 (#7)	3.6% (#22)	-0.37 (#26)
GB Defense	70.2% (#3)	-0.13 (#8)	15.3% (#29)	0.09 (#22)	6.1% (#21)	-0.21 (#4)

Run & Play Action Identity

UNIT	ZONE %	ZONE EPA	PA %	PA EPA	UC %	UC EPA
DET Offense	56.3% (#14)	-0.00 (#7)	33.3% (#3)	0.35 (#2)	50.3% (#3)	0.11 (#3)
GB Defense	55.8% (#15)	0.15 (#32)	25.2% (#18)	-0.09 (#7)	36.5% (#20)	-0.05 (#16)

Safety Shell & Middle of Field

UNIT	1-HIGH %	1-HIGH EPA	2-HIGH %	2-HIGH EPA	MOF %	MOF EPA
DET Offense	37.2% (#15)	0.30 (#3)	62.8% (#18)	0.24 (#6)	24.1% (#9)	0.45 (#9)
GB Defense	42.6% (#10)	-0.10 (#14)	57.4% (#23)	-0.17 (#3)	22.4% (#24)	-0.20 (#1)

Blitz & Pressure

UNIT	BLITZ %	BLITZ EPA	NON-BLITZ EPA	PRESSURE %	PRESSURE EPA
DET Offense	28.0% (#24)	0.36 (#1)	0.23 (#5)	37.7% (#12)	-0.25 (#10)
GB Defense	32.2% (#11)	-0.15 (#10)	-0.14 (#3)	38.8% (#20)	-0.51 (#6)

Pass Depth

UNIT	SHORT %	SHORT EPA	INTER. %	INTER. EPA	DEEP %	DEEP EPA
DET Offense	67.5% (#16)	0.12 (#6)	24.6% (#5)	0.93 (#2)	7.9% (#29)	1.20 (#3)
GB Defense	71.9% (#6)	0.01 (#16)	22.4% (#15)	-0.30 (#2)	5.7% (#32)	0.10 (#9)

Defensive Personnel & Box Count

UNIT	BASE %	BASE EPA	NICKEL %	NICKEL EPA	LIGHT BOX %	LIGHT BOX EPA
DET Offense	30.3% (#16)	0.09 (#8)	57.6% (#19)	0.21 (#2)	44.5% (#17)	0.23 (#5)
GB Defense	22.4% (#24)	-0.09 (#12)	75.8% (#5)	-0.12 (#10)	47.7% (#13)	-0.07 (#9)

What does the Bengals 12 personnel approach look like against the Ravens?

- The Bengals are in 12 personnel 47.7% of the time and that is the highest rate in the league. They are 6th in EPA/play out of 12 personnel and teams usually play nickel against them. The Ravens are 4th in EPA/play allowed against 12 personnel and run a fair share of cover 2 against it.
- The Bengals will likely continue to lean into their outside throws to Ja'Marr Chase and Tee Higgins, and for good reason. Cincinnati's outside throws against nickel and dime looks have produced 0.51 EPA/throw and a 55.1% success rate. Nate Wiggins ranks 9th in yards allowed per coverage snap, but Marlon Humphrey ranks 60th.

CIN Offense vs. BLT Defense

Week 7 preview • 2026 Weeks 1-6 data • Each cell shows value and NFL rank

Overall

UNIT	EPA/PLAY	EPA/DB	EPA/RUSH	SUCCESS RATE	PASS OE	EXPLOSIVE %
CIN Offense	0.05 (#8)	0.13 (#9)	-0.11 (#18)	45.8% (#10)	7.8% (#2)	8.4% (#19)
BLT Defense	-0.08 (#11)	-0.09 (#7)	-0.06 (#25)	40.7% (#5)	0.1% (#17)	8.1% (#9)

Personnel Usage

UNIT	11P %	11P EPA	12P %	12P EPA	21P %	21P EPA
CIN Offense	43.2% (#28)	0.00 (#11)	47.7% (#1)	0.16 (#6)	5.2% (#10)	-0.62 (#24)
BLT Defense	70.5% (#2)	-0.04 (#16)	21.1% (#22)	-0.24 (#4)	2.4% (#25)	-0.55 (#5)

Run & Play Action Identity

UNIT	ZONE %	ZONE EPA	PA %	PA EPA	UC %	UC EPA
CIN Offense	69.1% (#4)	-0.10 (#16)	18.6% (#30)	-0.03 (#22)	25.3% (#31)	-0.13 (#24)
BLT Defense	64.8% (#5)	-0.15 (#15)	20.3% (#29)	-0.52 (#1)	35.8% (#23)	-0.13 (#8)

Safety Shell & Middle of Field

UNIT	1-HIGH %	1-HIGH EPA	2-HIGH %	2-HIGH EPA	MOF %	MOF EPA
CIN Offense	42.2% (#6)	-0.05 (#17)	57.8% (#27)	0.27 (#3)	23.3% (#10)	0.34 (#12)
BLT Defense	18.1% (#31)	-0.25 (#6)	81.9% (#2)	-0.05 (#9)	22.3% (#23)	0.04 (#8)

Blitz & Pressure

UNIT	BLITZ %	BLITZ EPA	NON-BLITZ EPA	PRESSURE %	PRESSURE EPA
CIN Offense	27.0% (#26)	-0.18 (#22)	0.25 (#4)	36.3% (#9)	-0.27 (#14)
BLT Defense	29.3% (#13)	-0.11 (#13)	-0.08 (#6)	39.7% (#17)	-0.48 (#9)

Pass Depth

UNIT	SHORT %	SHORT EPA	INTER. %	INTER. EPA	DEEP %	DEEP EPA
CIN Offense	69.3% (#10)	-0.18 (#30)	22.8% (#13)	0.95 (#1)	7.9% (#28)	1.54 (#2)
BLT Defense	67.0% (#19)	-0.20 (#4)	24.4% (#8)	0.62 (#24)	8.6% (#30)	0.62 (#22)

Defensive Personnel & Box Count

UNIT	BASE %	BASE EPA	NICKEL %	NICKEL EPA	LIGHT BOX %	LIGHT BOX EPA
CIN Offense	16.9% (#31)	-0.03 (#17)	74.4% (#4)	0.02 (#10)	49.4% (#7)	0.27 (#4)
BLT Defense	18.2% (#27)	-0.31 (#2)	48.5% (#29)	-0.04 (#19)	56.6% (#2)	0.05 (#19)

What happens when the Chiefs run game meets the Seahawks defensive line?

- Kenneth Walker is one of our favorite stories of this season. He is 1st in yards per carry, 3rd in yards before contact, and 2nd in yards after contact. He is an absolute force that is running behind an offensive line that can pave the way with effective double teams.
- This will be a strength-on-strength matchup as the Seahawks defense allows the 6th fewest yards per carry and 3rd fewest yards after contact on outside zone runs this season. Seattle does have a lower ranked EPA/carry allowed against inside zone, and Walker is averaging 6.08 yards per inside zone carry. We can't wait to watch the battles on the interior in this game.

KC Offense vs. SEA Defense

Week 7 preview • 2026 Weeks 1-6 data • Each cell shows value and NFL rank

Overall

UNIT	EPA/PLAY	EPA/DB	EPA/RUSH	SUCCESS RATE	PASS OE	EXPLOSIVE %
KC Offense	0.13 (#4)	0.15 (#8)	0.10 (#1)	49.2% (#3)	4.6% (#8)	12.9% (#2)
SEA Defense	-0.18 (#2)	-0.15 (#3)	-0.21 (#2)	37.5% (#3)	-2.7% (#7)	5.9% (#3)

Personnel Usage

UNIT	11P %	11P EPA	12P %	12P EPA	13P %	13P EPA
KC Offense	55.1% (#23)	0.14 (#4)	32.3% (#6)	-0.05 (#18)	9.6% (#12)	0.29 (#4)
SEA Defense	55.5% (#21)	-0.14 (#6)	20.8% (#23)	-0.27 (#3)	8.5% (#16)	-0.53 (#1)

Run & Play Action Identity

UNIT	ZONE %	ZONE EPA	PA %	PA EPA	UC %	UC EPA
KC Offense	60.5% (#11)	0.06 (#3)	36.0% (#2)	0.28 (#6)	40.1% (#15)	0.12 (#1)
SEA Defense	58.3% (#10)	-0.13 (#17)	27.2% (#12)	-0.19 (#5)	38.0% (#16)	-0.26 (#2)

Safety Shell & Middle of Field

UNIT	1-HIGH %	1-HIGH EPA	2-HIGH %	2-HIGH EPA	MOF %	MOF EPA
KC Offense	43.1% (#4)	0.09 (#9)	56.9% (#29)	0.20 (#10)	24.7% (#8)	0.03 (#26)
SEA Defense	18.3% (#30)	-0.64 (#1)	81.7% (#3)	-0.04 (#10)	16.7% (#4)	-0.07 (#3)

Blitz & Pressure

UNIT	BLITZ %	BLITZ EPA	NON-BLITZ EPA	PRESSURE %	PRESSURE EPA
KC Offense	28.7% (#22)	0.20 (#7)	0.13 (#8)	35.6% (#6)	-0.09 (#7)
SEA Defense	21.1% (#31)	-0.46 (#2)	-0.07 (#7)	40.8% (#13)	-0.42 (#12)

Pass Depth

UNIT	SHORT %	SHORT EPA	INTER. %	INTER. EPA	DEEP %	DEEP EPA
KC Offense	74.7% (#3)	0.14 (#4)	13.9% (#31)	0.59 (#5)	11.4% (#15)	0.31 (#21)
SEA Defense	74.4% (#1)	0.10 (#24)	15.6% (#31)	-0.47 (#1)	10.0% (#21)	-0.50 (#2)

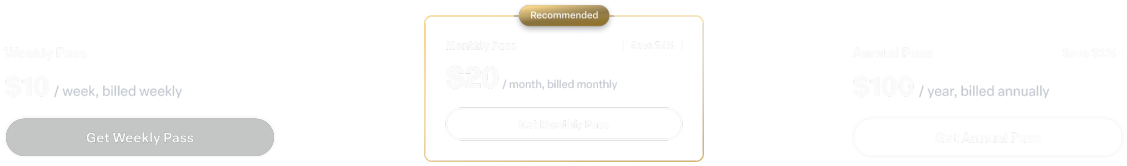
Defensive Personnel & Box Count

UNIT	BASE %	BASE EPA	NICKEL %	NICKEL EPA	LIGHT BOX %	LIGHT BOX EPA
KC Offense	27.4% (#20)	0.18 (#3)	65.3% (#11)	0.06 (#9)	43.2% (#20)	0.06 (#13)
SEA Defense	12.4% (#31)	-0.43 (#1)	69.3% (#10)	-0.20 (#4)	48.5% (#9)	-0.09 (#8)

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